

Aicruae Funeral Traditions

Aicruae — Funeral Customs

A culture's grief made visible. The Aicruan funeral is not private. It marks the mourner's body, the road they walk, and the air around them. The dead do not simply leave — they are sent.

Quick Facts

Cultural Philosophy	Grief is public, ritualized, and physically inscribed on the mourner's body
Deities Invoked (multiple — see below)	Razar (the soul's ascent), Nellebrie (the disaster of loss), and others depending on relationship and region
No Single Death Deity	Aicruae has no specific god of death or the underworld. Funerals are polytheistic — different gods are invoked for different aspects of the loss.
Disposition of the Body	Class-coded. Royalty and high nobility are entombed. Commoners are cremated on pyres.
Universal Ritual Items	Iksyre (headdress), Broep (chain veil), red paint markings, bare feet, the Geina, a strand of the deceased's hair
Gendered Element	Male mourners wear an Eye Bind (sheer black cloth). Female mourners do not.

The Polytheistic Funeral

Aicruae has no single god of death or the underworld. This shapes funeral practice profoundly. Where a culture with a death god might funnel all funeral prayers through one deity, Aicruan funerals invoke multiple gods — each for a specific aspect of what is happening.

Razar (Sun God) — for the soul's ascent.

The smoke from the burning hair and the Geina rises toward the sun. Razar

receives it. The body, whether buried or burned, is mortal flesh that returns to its element; the soul ascends as smoke. Every Aicruan funeral, regardless of class or region, invokes Razar.

Nellebrie (Goddess of Disasters) — for the disaster of the loss itself.

A death is not just a death. It is a disaster for those left behind. Nellebrie is invoked not as a death deity but as the goddess who presides over what is now broken — the household without its head, the regiment without its captain, the child without their parent. She is invoked to acknowledge that something has been *destroyed* by this loss, not just changed. This is why Solis chose to bury Princess Iris and Prince Orcus beneath a temple of Nellebrie at Rewqo. The Aicruan Civil War was the disaster. Burying its victims at her temple was a confession dressed as devotion. [INFERRED — confirm reading.]

Other deities invoked depending on context.

- *Paha (Goddess of Horses, Nellebrie's mother)* — for those who died in cavalry service or whose families work with horses
- *Zopha (Sea Goddess)* — for fishermen, sailors, and those who died at sea (heavily invoked in Northern Aicruae)
- *[TBD additional deities]* — confirm which other gods in the Aicruan pantheon get specific funeral invocations and under what circumstances

Class and Regional Variation

Noble funerals tend to invoke more deities than commoner funerals — partly because nobles can afford longer ceremonies, partly because invoking more gods is a status display. Regional variation is significant: a Northern Isles fisherman's funeral might invoke Razar and Zopha primarily, with Nellebrie only briefly. A noble funeral in Lajazer might invoke five or six deities across an extended ceremony.

The Mourner's Regalia

The Iksyre — Ceremonial Headdress

A flat, circular headdress worn atop the head by mourners during funerary rites. The Iksyre is a symbol of grief, humility, and reverence for the dead.

The Noble Iksyre

The full ceremonial Iksyre is a heavy, flat steel disk — circular, often etched with sacred markings or family sigils on its upper face. Beneath it hangs the Broep. It is worn by nobles and royal mourners during formal funerary processions.

The Commoner's Iksyre

Commoners construct their own makeshift Iksyres. The shape and meaning are the same — a flat circular disk worn atop the head — but the materials are whatever a household can afford or improvise. [INFERRED: likely wood, leather, woven reed, or hammered tin in place of steel; the chains beneath may be twine, rope, or simple cord rather than steel and wire. Confirm specifics or leave open for regional variation.]

Symbolism

The flat circle echoes Razar's disk in the sky. To wear it is to bow under the sun's witness. The mourner does not stand in their own light during grief — they stand under his.

The Broep — Chain Veil

A veil of interlinked steel chains and wire that hangs from the lower edge of the Iksyre. It obscures the mourner's face from the world, severing them from the living for the duration of the rite.

The Broep is heavy. Wearing it is uncomfortable. This is intentional — grief is a weight, and the Broep makes the weight visible.

The chains end in small weighted beads or drops, which sway and click softly as the mourner moves. The sound carries during processions and is sometimes called *the rain of the dead* in older Aicruan poetry. [INFERRED — may not be canon; flag for confirmation.]

For commoners, the makeshift Broep may be made of simpler materials — strips of dark cloth, knotted twine, beaded cord, or thin chain salvaged from common workshop scraps.

The Eye Bind — Male Mourners Only

A strip of translucent black cloth used to bind the eyes of male mourners. It represents the turning inward and the refusal to witness the world in mourning.

Why male mourners only: [INFERRED — needs your confirmation.] In Aicruae's patriarchal culture, men hold the public weight of authority — they witness contracts, validate truth in court, and "see" the kingdom into its decisions. The Eye Bind inverts that authority during grief. By binding their eyes, they refuse to witness the world while it has been diminished by loss. They will not legitimize the death by looking on the world that allowed it. Female mourners do not need the binding — their grief is expected to be visible through the markings and the procession itself, not through refusal to see.

The cloth is sheer enough that the mourner can perceive shapes and movement, but not faces or detail. Male mourners are typically guided by a younger relative or a priestly attendant during the procession.

Body Preparation of the Mourner

The mourner's own body is marked and prepared as part of the rite.

Red Paint Markings

The mourner is painted with traditional red markings across the body — face, neck, chest, arms, sometimes the back. These markings are paint, not tattoos. They are washed away after the mourning period ends.

The patterns are traditional and likely vary by region and house. [TBD — confirm: are there standard mourning patterns? Sigils tied to specific houses? Marks specific to relationship with the deceased (parent, spouse, child)?]

The color is symbolic. Red is the color of life — blood, the heart, the warmth that the body loses in death. To paint the mourner in red is to mark them as still living, still bleeding warmth, while they walk beside someone who no longer can.

The Forehead Mark

A small red dot is placed at the center of the mourner's forehead, between the brows. [INFERRED meaning: the eye that does not close, the witness the soul carries. Confirm or revise.]

Red Hands and Feet

The mourner's hands and feet are dyed deep red — not painted in patterns, but fully colored. The dye soaks the skin and stains for days after the funeral.

Barefoot Procession

Mourners walk barefoot during funeral processions. Combined with the dyed feet, this means they leave a trail of red footprints behind them as they walk.

This is the most striking visual element of an Aicruan funeral. The dead's path through the living world is literally marked on the road. After the procession, the footprints fade with rain and traffic, mirroring the way grief fades from public memory while remaining inside the mourner's body.

[TBD — does the funeral procession follow a specific route? From the home to the temple? From the temple to the burial site or pyre? The route choice determines where the red footprints accumulate, and may have political weight (e.g., a noble funeral procession passing through commoner districts).]

The Geina and the Hair

Two items burn at every Aicruan funeral, regardless of class.

A Strand of the Dead's Hair

Cut from the deceased before the body is prepared. Burning the hair sends a part of the deceased's physical self up to Razar with the smoke. It is the body's first act of ascending, even before disposition.

The Geina — "Item Treasured"

Geina translates to *item treasured*. It is something the deceased loved — an object they were known to cherish in life. It is given to the fire so that the deceased has something familiar with them in their journey beyond.

The Geina is chosen by family or close friends, ideally someone who knew the deceased intimately. The wrong Geina is considered a failure of love — a sign that no one truly knew what the dead held dear.

Examples of Geinas in canon or implied by canon: [TBD — open for additions.]

For mourners attending the funeral, watching the Geina burn is the moment they say goodbye. The hair represents the body letting go. The Geina represents the world letting go.

Disposition of the Body — Class-Coded

This is where Aicruae splits.

Royalty and High Nobility — Entombment

Royals and high-ranking nobles are buried, not burned. Their bodies are placed in tombs, crypts, or beneath sacred sites. The body is preserved as monument; the soul has already been sent upward through the Geina-and-hair burning.

Canonical examples:

- **Princess Iris Aleka Patton** (died 7,218 BR, Battle of Rewqo) — buried by Solis beneath a temple of Nellebrie at Rewqo
- **Prince Orcus Emere Patton** (died after Iris) — buried by Solis at the same site, beneath the same temple

Implications: Noble tombs are political objects. Where a noble is buried, what's etched on the tomb, who is allowed to visit — these are statements of power. Solis burying Iris and Orcus together beneath a temple of Nellebrie is doing several things at once: marking them as honored dead, claiming them permanently, framing the civil war that killed them as a *disaster* under Nellebrie's domain, and binding them to a sacred site he chose. This is consistent with the cultural rule and also reads as a possessive act on his part. The choice of Nellebrie's temple specifically — Goddess of Disasters — is its own confession. Solis was naming what he had done.

Tomb construction: [TBD — who builds noble tombs? Are they prepared in advance during the noble's lifetime, or commissioned after death? Family crypts vs. temple-affiliated burials? Grave goods?]

Commoners — Cremation by Pyre

Commoners are cremated on pyres. The body burns with the hair and the Geina. The ashes are then [TBD — scattered? Kept in urns? Buried in family plots? Given

to a river or the sea? Each choice has very different cultural weight].

The pyre site: [TBD — built where? Sacred grove? Temple grounds? Designated village pyre site? Funeral specifics likely vary by region — coastal communities may use sea-pyres or boat-pyres given Northern Aicruae's maritime culture; farming villages may have established communal pyre fields.]

Who lights the pyre: [TBD — eldest surviving child? A local priest? A specific role? This matters for inheritance and family politics.]

Cost: Pyres are not free — fuel is fuel, and the poorest families may struggle to afford a proper one. There may be temple charity that covers cremation costs for the destitute, or a "shared pyre" practice where multiple bodies burn together. [INFERRED — confirm or revise.]

Why the Class Split

The Aicruan worldview holds that the soul is what matters most. The hair and the Geina ritual sends the soul upward in every funeral. The body is what's left over. For commoners, returning the body to ash and air is the natural conclusion — the same fire that sent the soul takes the rest. For nobility, the body itself becomes a political and dynastic object; preserving it as monument keeps the family's presence in the world.

This split also reinforces class hierarchy in death the same way it does in life. A noble's tomb is a place. A commoner's pyre is an event. One persists; the other concludes.

The Procession

[INFERRED in part — confirm specifics.]

A funeral procession in Aicruae is a public march. Mourners wearing Ikisyres and Broeps walk together, painted in red, leaving the trail of red footprints. The pace is slow, deliberate. The chains of the Broeps click as the group moves.

For nobles, the procession may stretch through the capital or a major town, with the deceased carried on a bier and crowds gathering to watch. The route is chosen for political and religious meaning.

For commoners, the procession may be smaller — family and close friends walking from the home to the village pyre site. But the ritual elements remain the same: the makeshift lksyres, the red paint, the bare feet, the trail.

The procession ends at the disposition site — the tomb for nobles, the pyre for commoners. There the hair and the Geina are burned. The mourners remove their lksyres at the end of the rite. The Eye Bind is removed last, by an attendant for male mourners, signaling the mourner's return to the world of the living.

The Mourning Period

[TBD — duration unclear in canon. Some questions to nail down:]

- How long is formal mourning? Days? Weeks? A full year for spouses?
 - Do mourners continue to wear any element of the regalia after the funeral itself (e.g., a small red mark for a year)?
 - Are there annual remembrance rites?
 - How does the mourning period affect work, marriage, public life? Can a noble in mourning attend court? Can a peasant in mourning be exempted from labor?
 - Is there a specific period before the body can be entombed/burned (preparation rituals, washing, dressing)?
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Notable Aicruan Funerals in Canon

Princess Iris Aleka Patton (died 7,218 BR)

Killed by Solis at the Battle of Rewqo after being deserted by her knights, captured alive, escaping, killing 15 men, and being killed by Solis himself. Buried beneath a temple of Nellebrie at Rewqo.

Prince Orcus Emere Patton (died shortly after Iris)

Buried at the same site as Iris, beneath the same temple. The decision to entomb them together carries weight given their political opposition during the civil war.

[TBD — other major canonical funerals to add: deaths during the civil war (House Orana burned alive — was this a funeral or only an execution?), King Hailour Layern Patton I, Sevtor of House Orana, Esterica, etc.]

Open Questions for Future Sessions

The following are inferences I made or details still unconfirmed. Worth nailing down before this section enters final canon:

1. **Female mourners' equivalent ritual.** If men wear the Eye Bind to refuse to witness, do women have a parallel inward act? Or is the absence itself meaningful — that women are expected to witness everything, even grief, while men are permitted to look away?
2. **Specific patterns of the red markings.** Are there standard mourning patterns? Patterns that change based on relationship to the deceased? Patterns specific to noble houses?
3. **The Broep's "rain of the dead" sound — invented by me or canon?** I added this as descriptive detail. Cut, keep, or revise.
4. **Where ashes go after cremation** — scattered, kept, buried, given to water?
5. **The pyre site, who lights it, and what happens for the destitute.**
6. **The procession route logic** — is it always home-to-disposition-site, or does it stop at temples, ancestral homes, or politically meaningful locations?
7. **Mourning duration** and what wearing/showing of grief continues after the funeral itself.
8. ~~Nellebrie's role in funeral rites.~~ **RESOLVED:** Nellebrie is the Goddess of Disasters. There is no death-specific deity in the Aicruan pantheon. Funerals are polytheistic — Razar receives the soul, Nellebrie acknowledges the disaster of loss, and other gods are invoked based on the deceased's life and the mourners' relationship. Solis burying Iris and Orcus at her temple was about framing the civil war as the disaster, not about Nellebrie being a death goddess.
9. **Burial alternatives for the body itself in cremation cases** — does anything physical of the body remain (relic bones, lock of hair kept by family) the way medieval European Catholic culture preserved relics?
10. **What happens to the lksyre and Broep after the funeral?** Returned to the temple? Kept in the family? Destroyed? For nobles, are the steel ones

inherited?

Sourcing Key: Direct canon = drawn from your hub docs and the new funeral imagery you sent. [INFERRED] = reasonable extrapolation flagged for your confirmation. [TBD] = open question that needs a canonical answer.

Last updated: May 2026 — Awaiting clarification on open questions; integration with Aicruae main page Culture > Funeral Customs section pending.